

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250271514

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

August 28, 2025

Inventor(s)

NEUNER; Severin et al.

TWO-DIMENSIONAL MAGNET-BASED POSITIONING SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR PERFORMING A MAGNET-BASED POSITION DETERMINATION

Abstract

Disclosed is a magnet-based positioning system including an axially magnetized magnet, wherein two opposing magnetic poles are arranged along a common z-axis, and a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis. The magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and to determine a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and to determine an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the magnet based on the first and second magnetic field vectors and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

Inventors: NEUNER; Severin (Valley, DE), LEISENHEIMER; Stephan (Oberhaching, DE), VALTL; Jakob (München, DE), PARK; Joo Il (Sungnam-Si, KR), KIM; Hyun Jeong (Seoul, KR)

Applicant: Infineon Technologies AG (Neubiberg, DE)

Family ID: 1000008466872

Appl. No.: 19/062761

Filed: February 25, 2025

Foreign Application Priority Data

DE 102024201808.2

Feb. 27, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G01R33/02 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G01R33/0206 (20130101);

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] This application claims priority to Germany Patent Application No. 102024201808.2 filed on Feb. 27, 2024, the content of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

FIELD

[0002] Implementations of the present disclosure relate to a magnet-based positioning system and to a method for a magnet-based position determination. The innovative concept uses a two-dimensional approach, wherein magnetic field vectors are determined in a two-dimensional x-y-plane.

BACKGROUND

[0003] In some applications it is useful to determine an exact position of a magnet relative to a magnetic sensor. For example, wireless charging of autonomous robots may require that the robots can position themselves towards a wireless charging module at an optimal position in terms of highest charging efficiency. Accordingly, autonomous robots that need to be charged have to know where to go and how to position themselves in the charging stand.

[0004] Magnetic solutions are already known, in which the robots comprise a magnetic sensor arrangement for locating a magnet being installed at the charging site. However, these concepts apply a time- and energy-consuming iterative concept, in which a robot has to move step by step closer in the direction of the magnet. Other magnet-based positioning systems require an initial calibration and further regular on-site calibrations, since they may be temperature dependent or dependent on the absolute magnetic field strength.

[0005] It would therefore be desirable to improve existing magnet-based positioning systems so that they do not require on-site calibration, enable high-precision positioning and are energy- and cost-efficient.

SUMMARY

[0006] This goal is achieved using the herein disclosed magnet-based positioning system and the corresponding method for performing a magnet-based position determination according to the independent claims. Further implementations and advantageous aspects are suggested in the dependent claims.

[0007] The innovative magnet-based positioning system includes an axially magnetized magnet, wherein two opposing magnetic poles are arranged along a common z-axis, and a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the magnet. The magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing the direction of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane. The magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position (e.g., indicated by first x-y-coordinates (x.sub.1|y.sub.1)) in the x-y-plane, and to determine a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position (e.g., indicated by second x-y-coordinates (x.sub.2|y.sub.2)) in the x-y-plane. The magnetic sensor arrangement is further configured to determine an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the magnet based on the first and second magnetic field vectors and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0008] The corresponding innovative method for performing the magnet-based position determination includes a step of providing an axially magnetized magnet, wherein two opposing magnetic poles are arranged along a common z-axis, and a step of providing a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing the direction of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane. The method further includes a step of determining a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position (e.g., indicated by first x-y-coordinates (x.sub.1|y.sub.1)) in the x-y-plane, and determining a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position (e.g., indicated by second x-y-coordinates (x.sub.2|y.sub.2)) in the x-y-plane. The method further includes a step of determining an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the magnet based on the first and second magnetic field vectors and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0009] Accordingly, even though the two positions are yet unknown to the magnetic sensor arrangement, it may exactly calculate its own position relative to the magnet by only having knowledge about the spatial distance between the two yet unknown positions and by combining both magnetic field vectors with each

other in an appropriate way.

[0010] According to a further aspect, computer programs are provided, wherein each of the computer programs is configured to implement the above-described method when being executed on a computer or signal processor, so that the above-described method is implemented by one of the computer programs.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] In the following, implementations of the present disclosure are described in more detail with reference to the figures, in which

[0012] FIG. 1A shows a schematic perspective view of commonly known axially magnetized permanent magnet.

[0013] FIG. 1B shows a schematic perspective view of commonly known diametrically magnetized permanent magnet.

[0014] FIG. 2A shows an implementation of a magnet-based positioning system comprising an axially magnetized magnet and an axially spaced apart x-y sensor plane that is perpendicular to the magnetizing axis of the magnet, where emanating magnetic field lines are schematically depicted.

[0015] FIG. 2B shows a schematic representation of magnetic field lines emanated from the magnet, as seen from the x-y sensor plane.

[0016] FIG. 3A shows an example of an axially magnetized magnet but with x-z sensor plane that is parallel to the magnetizing axis of the magnet, where emanating magnetic field lines are schematically depicted.

[0017] FIG. 3B shows a schematic representation of magnetic field lines emanated from the magnet, as seen from the x-y sensor plane.

[0018] FIG. 4 shows a schematic representation of magnetic field lines and magnetic field vectors in the x-y-plane with a magnetic sensor arrangement comprising two magnetic sensor elements according to an implementation.

[0019] FIG. 5 shows a further schematic representation of the magnetic field lines and magnetic field vectors of FIG. 4 according to an implementation.

[0020] FIG. 6 shows a schematic representation of magnetic field lines and magnetic field vectors in the x-y-plane with a magnetic sensor arrangement comprising one single magnetic sensor element according to an implementation.

[0021] FIG. 7 shows a schematic representation of magnetic field lines and magnetic field vectors in the x-y-plane with a magnetic sensor arrangement configured to solve ambiguity problems caused by two identical magnetic field angles according to an implementation, and

[0022] FIG. 8 shows a schematic block diagram of an innovative method according to an implementation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0023] Equal or equivalent elements or elements with equal or equivalent functionality are denoted in the following description by equal or equivalent reference numerals.

[0024] Although some aspects will be described in the context of an apparatus, it is clear that these aspects also represent a description of the corresponding method, where a block or device corresponds to a method step or a feature of a method step. Analogously, aspects described in the context of a method step also represent a description of a corresponding block or item or feature of a corresponding apparatus.

[0025] Method steps which are depicted using a block diagram and which are described with reference to the block diagram may also be executed in an order different from the depicted and/or described order.

Furthermore, method steps concerning a particular feature of a device may be replaceable with the feature of the device, and the other way around.

[0026] Furthermore, for ease of understanding of the following description, an x-y-z coordinate system is represented. The depicted z-axis corresponds to the magnetizing axis of the axially magnetized magnet. Accordingly, the terms z-axis and magnetizing axis may be used interchangeably in the following description.

[0027] Some applications require an exact position adjustment of two devices relative to each other. For example, in high precision positioning applications, trays or the like need to be precisely positioned in machines for industrial or medical applications. A further field of application covers active motion compensation, where a readjustment due to environmental disturbance in optical applications may be

required. Furthermore, fast and accurate adaption in workflow/production may be required, e.g., by readjusting a tool-head in food production or in an assembly lane. Yet further, nearfield navigation may require an exact position adjustment, e.g., autonomous robots navigating into an optimal wireless charging position.

[0028] For such positioning tasks, magnetic solutions are known, in which a magnet and a magnetic sensor are provided. Conventional magnetic positioning systems use the magnet's magnetic field strength for adjusting the relative position between the sensor and the magnet, e.g., the higher the field strength the closer the distance between magnet and sensor. However, such magnet-based positioning systems require an initial calibration and further regular on-site calibrations, since they may be temperature dependent or dependent on the absolute magnetic field strength.

[0029] The present innovative concept, instead, is independent from the magnetic field strength. It uses an angle calculation of at least two magnetic field vectors. Thus, it is independent from temperature and absolute magnetic field strength rendering it calibration-free. Furthermore, xMR sensors (e.g., TMR, AMR, GMR, etc.) may be used for the present innovative concept which sensors only require low power and which comprise an intrinsic low noise behavior.

[0030] For a brief introduction, FIG. 1A shows an axially magnetized cylinder magnet **110** that is characterized in that its north pole **112** and its south pole **113** are arranged along a vertical axis **111** extending through the magnet **110** along its height h , e.g., perpendicular to its diameter d . In other words, the magnet's north pole **112** and south pole **113** are arranged at the top and bottom of the magnet **110**. The vertical axis **111** may also be referred to as a vertical magnetizing axis.

[0031] FIG. 1B, in turn, shows a diametrically magnetized cylinder magnet **210** that is characterized in that its north pole **212** and its south pole **213** are arranged along a diametrical axis **211** extending along the diameter d of the magnet **210**, e.g., perpendicular to its height h . In other words, the magnet's north pole **212** and south pole **213** are arranged at the left and right side of the magnet **210**. The diametrical axis **211** may also be referred to as a diametrical magnetizing axis.

[0032] FIG. 2A shows an implementation of an innovative magnet-based positioning system **100**. It comprises an axially magnetized magnet **110**. The axially magnetized magnet **110** may comprise a symmetrical cylinder or ring shape, though other geometrical shapes are also possible. Two opposing magnetic poles **112**, **113** of the magnet **110** are arranged along a common z-axis **111**, which corresponds to the above described magnetizing axis of the magnet **110**. A coordinate system **150** that is schematically depicted in FIG. 2A shows the orientation of the z-axis **111**. In this example, the z-axis **111** extends vertically through the magnet **110** along its height h (c.f. FIG. 1A).

[0033] As can be seen, a plurality of magnetic field lines **140** emanate from the magnet **110** in a way as is known in this field of technology. As can further be seen, an x-y-plane **130** is depicted in FIG. 2A, the x-y-plane being spanned such that it extends perpendicular to the aforementioned z-axis **111** (magnetizing axis). In particular, each one of an x-axis and a y-axis of the x-y-plane **130** is perpendicular to the z-axis **111** (magnetizing axis). Accordingly, the x-y-plane **130** is perpendicular to the magnetizing axis **111** of the magnet **110**.

[0034] The x-y-plane **130** is axially, e.g., along the z-axis **111** (magnetizing axis) spaced apart from the magnet **110**. In this non-limiting example, the x-y-plane **130** is located above the magnet **110**. However, it may also be possible that the x-y-plane **130** would be located below the magnet **110**.

[0035] The x-y-plane **130** represents a sensor plane, e.g., a plane in which an innovative magnetic sensor arrangement (not depicted here) is arranged. Accordingly, the innovative magnet-based positioning system **100** comprises a magnetic sensor arrangement that is axially spaced apart from the magnet **110**. One can say, the magnet **110** and the magnetic sensor arrangement are arranged in two different spaced apart x-y-planes.

[0036] As will be described further below, some implementations may provide for a magnetic sensor arrangement comprising one single magnetic sensor element, or exactly two magnetic sensor elements, or exactly three magnetic sensor elements. More than three magnetic sensor elements may also be possible.

[0037] The innovative magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine magnetic field vectors in the x-y-plane **130**, the magnetic field vectors representing the direction of the emanated magnetic field lines **140** in the x-y-plane **130**. The magnetic field lines **140** themselves comprise a magnitude and a direction. Thus, they may also be referred to as magnetic field vectors, and the magnetic field may be referred to as a magnetic vector field. The innovative magnetic sensor arrangement may be configured to measure the direction, and optionally also the magnitude, of the magnetic field vectors **140**.

[0038] FIG. 2B shows a top view from the x-y-plane **130** onto the magnet **110**. Since the x-y-plane **130** is

perfectly orthogonal to the z-axis **111**, the magnetic field vectors **140** are perfectly symmetrical, namely perfectly radial with respect to the center **114** of the magnet **110**. In other words, the magnetic field vectors **140** of the axially magnetized magnet **110** always point towards, or away from, the center **114** of the magnet **110**. This is also what the magnetic sensor arrangement sees. One big advantage of this constellation is the fact that the symmetry of the magnetic field vectors **140** does not depend on the magnetic field strength, e.g., the magnetic sensor arrangement always sees the same radial pattern of the magnetic field vectors **140** irrespective of the magnetic field strength of the magnet **110**.

[0039] FIGS. **3A** and **3B**, in turn, show a scenario in which a sensor arrangement is arranged in an x-z-plane **131**. In contrast to FIGS. **2A** and **2B**, the x-z-plane **130** is not perpendicular but parallel to the magnetizing axis **111** of the magnet **110**. The same holds for a (not depicted) y-z-plane.

[0040] In case of such parallel planes, the magnetic field vectors **140** are not perfectly radial, but they are curved instead, wherein the curves point towards the magnet **110** or away from it. The same holds for a y-z-plane. The curvy pattern of the magnetic field vectors **140** highly depends on the magnetic field strength. Without calibration it is nearly impossible to exactly determine the position of the magnet **110** using a magnetic sensor being arranged in a plane **131** being oriented parallel to the magnet axis **111** of the magnet **110**.

[0041] FIG. **4** shows a view from the x-y-plane **130** as previously discussed with reference to FIGS. **2A** and **2B**. As an example, an autonomous robot may be equipped with the magnetic sensor arrangement, while a charging site may be equipped with the magnet **110**, or the other way around. The depicted x-y-plane **130**, in which the magnetic sensor arrangement is arranged, is perpendicular to the magnet axis **111** of the axially magnetized magnet **110**. Accordingly, the magnetic sensor arrangement being provided on the robot sees the magnetic field vectors **140** as exemplarily depicted in FIG. **4**. With the herein discussed innovative concept, the robot may precisely determine its position and/or orientation and/or location relative to the magnet **110** provided at the charging site. Thus, the robot may drive to an optimal charging position relative to the magnet **110**.

[0042] In the implementation shown in FIG. **4**, the sensor arrangement may comprise a first magnetic sensor element **151** and a second magnetic sensor element **152**. The first magnetic sensor element **151** is located at a first yet unknown position, which is exemplarily indicated with a first x-y-coordinate (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) in the x-y-plane **130**. The second magnetic sensor element **152** is located at a different second yet unknown position, which is exemplarily indicated with a second x-y-coordinate (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) in the x-y-plane **130**. The positions (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) of the magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** are unknown with respect to the position of the magnet **110**, e.g., the relative position between the magnetic sensor arrangement and the magnet **110** are yet unknown.

[0043] The first and second magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** are spaced apart from each other, wherein a spatial distance (dx|dy) between the first and second magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** is known to the magnetic sensor arrangement. Accordingly, the spatial distance between the first magnetic sensor element **151** and the second magnetic sensor element **152** defines a known relative distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2).

[0044] The magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine a first magnetic field vector **141** at the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) in the x-y-plane **130**, e.g., using the first magnetic sensor element **151**. The magnetic sensor arrangement is further configured to determine a second magnetic field vector **142** at the different second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) in the x-y-plane **130**, e.g., using the second magnetic sensor element **152**. Other implementations with only one single magnetic sensor element, or with three different magnetic sensor elements will be discussed further below.

[0045] According to the innovative concept, the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the magnet **110** based on the aforementioned first and second magnetic field vectors **141**, **142** and based on the aforementioned known relative spatial distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2).

[0046] For example, the magnetic sensor arrangement may be configured to determine its actual x-y-position based on a two-dimensional triangulation using the first and second magnetic field vectors **141**, **142**. The triangulation may be performed with using the aforementioned known relative spatial distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) in combination with two angles.

[0047] As can be seen in FIG. **4**, due to the above discussed perfect symmetry of the magnetic field lines

140, magnetic field vector **141**, **142** may comprise an unambiguous magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$. The first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ describes an angle of the first magnetic field vector **141** extending between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the common z-axis **111**. The second magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ describes an angle of the second magnetic field vector **142** extending between the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) and the common z-axis **111**.

[0048] Since each magnetic field angle α always points towards the center of the magnet **110**, which is represented by the common z-axis **111**, any magnetic field angle α may be calculated by the following equation:

$$[00001] \quad \alpha = \text{atan2}\left(\frac{y}{x}\right) \quad [\text{eq. 1}]$$

[0049] However, a distance information, e.g., a distance between the magnetic sensor arrangement and the magnet **110**, may still be missing. However, this can be solved by a measurement at multiple positions. In other words, by measuring the magnetic field angle α in the x-y-plane **130** at two or more locations, the exact position of the magnet **110** relative to the sensor arrangement can be calculated by using triangulation, as will be described in the following.

[0050] FIG. 5 shows an implementation of an innovative magnet-based position determination system **100** for calculating the missing distance information, e.g., the missing spatial distance between the magnetic sensor arrangement and the magnet **110**, wherein the missing distance information is exemplarily indicated by Δx and Δy . As mentioned above, the first position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) are both yet unknown. Only the relative distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) is known to the magnetic sensor arrangement.

[0051] Optionally, the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) may be set as a zero point (0|0) in the x-y-plane **130**. Then, the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) may be defined as (dx|dy), which indicate the known relative distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2).

[0052] The missing distance information, e.g., the yet unknown spatial distance between the magnetic sensor arrangement and the magnet **110** may now be calculated by calculating a spatial distance Δx , Δy between the first magnetic sensor arrangement **151** and the common z-axis **111** (=magnetizing axis), as exemplarily depicted in FIG. 5, and/or by calculating a spatial distance between the second magnetic sensor arrangement **152** and the common z-axis **111** (=magnetizing axis). As mentioned above, alternative implementations with only one single magnetic sensor element, or with three different magnetic sensor elements will be discussed further below.

[0053] Accordingly, while the spatial distance between the first magnetic sensor arrangement **151** and the common z-axis **111** (=magnetizing axis) may be defined as Δx , Δy , the spatial distance between the second magnetic sensor arrangement **152** and the common z-axis **111** (=magnetizing axis) may be defined as $\Delta x + dx$, $\Delta y + dy$.

[0054] These coordinates may now be inserted into above equation **1**, where $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ defines the first magnetic field angle belonging to the first magnetic field vector **141**, and $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ defines the second magnetic field angle belonging to the second magnetic field vector **142**:

$$[00002] \quad \tan(\alpha_1) = -\frac{x}{y} \quad [\text{eq. 2}] \quad \tan(\alpha_2) = -\frac{x+dx}{y+dy} \quad [\text{eq. 3}]$$

[0055] As can be seen, the above equations have two unknowns, namely Δx and Δy . Thus, equations 2 and 3 may be solved for Δx and Δy through substitution according to the following equations:

$$[00003] \quad x = -y \cdot \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_1) \quad [\text{eq. 4}] \quad x + dx = -(y + dy) \cdot \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_2) \quad [\text{eq. 5}]$$

$$y \cdot \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_2) - \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_1) = dx - dy \cdot \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_2) \quad [\text{eq. 6}]$$

$$y \cdot (\text{Math.tan}(\alpha_2) - \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_1)) = dx - dy \cdot \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_2) \quad [\text{eq. 7}]$$

[0056] Accordingly, the magnetic sensor arrangement may determine its actual x-y-position relative to the magnet **110** by calculating the spatial distance Δx , Δy between at least one of the first and second yet unknown positions (x.sub.1|y.sub.1), (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) and the common z-axis **111** (=magnetizing axis) based on the first and second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ and based on the known relative distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2).

[0057] The above equations can, however, only be solved when $\tan(\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}) \neq \tan(\alpha_{\text{sub.1}})$. That means physically that the first magnetic sensor element **151** and the second magnetic sensor element **152** are not allowed to be in one common line with the magnet **110**. In other words, the first magnetic sensor element

151 and the second magnetic sensor element **152** shall not lie on the same magnetic field line **140**.

[0058] FIG. **6** shows an alternative implementation, in which only one single sensor element **151** is used for determining the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the magnet **110**.

[0059] In this implementation, the magnet-based positioning system **100** may move the single magnetic sensor element **151** from the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) to the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) along a predetermined moving distance x=dx, y=dy. The predetermined moving distance x=dx, y=dy defines the aforementioned known relative distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2).

[0060] As schematically depicted in FIG. **6**, the single magnetic sensor element being located at the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) is referenced with reference numeral **151**, while the single magnetic sensor element being located at the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) is exemplarily referenced with reference numeral **151'**.

[0061] According to the innovative concept, the magnetic sensor arrangement may determine the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ when the single magnetic sensor element **151** is located at the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) according to the following equation:

[00004] $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}} = \text{atan2}\left(\frac{y}{x}\right)$ [eq. 10]

[0062] After moving the single magnetic sensor element **151** from the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) to the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2), the magnetic sensor arrangement may determine the second magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ according to the following equation:

[00005] $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}} = \text{atan2}\left(\frac{y}{x}\right)$ [eq. 11]

[0063] When moving the single magnetic sensor element **151** from the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) to the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) by the known distance (dx|dy), the single magnetic sensor element **151** should not be moved into a direction (forwards/backwards) along the current magnetic field line **140**, because then the magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ would be identical. In other words, the magnet-based positioning system **100** may move the single magnetic sensor element **151** in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ (forwards along magnetic field line **140**) and different to the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ plus/minus 180° (backwards along magnetic field line **140**).

[0064] For example, the magnet-based positioning system **100** may move the single magnetic sensor element **151** in a direction perpendicular to the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, such as exemplarily depicted in FIG. **6**.

[0065] After having calculated the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ for the first magnetic field vector **141** according to equation 10 and the second magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ for the second magnetic field vector **142** according to equation 11, the missing distance information Δx , Δy may be calculated in the same way as in the implementation above (FIG. **4**) according to equations 2 to 7 leading to the same following results as above:

[00006] $y = \frac{dx - dy \cdot \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_{\text{sub.2}})}{\tan(\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}) - \tan(\alpha_{\text{sub.1}})}$ $x = y \cdot \text{Math.tan}(\alpha_{\text{sub.1}})$

[0066] As mentioned above, the single magnetic sensor element **151** should not be moved into a direction (forwards/backwards) along the current magnetic field line **140** otherwise the first and second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ would be identical leading to the consequence that the above equations cannot be solved. The same problem may occur if, in case of the above implementation with two magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** (FIG. **4**), both magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** would be located on the same magnetic field line **140**.

[0067] In order to solve such ambiguity problems, the two magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** (FIG. **4**), or the single magnetic sensor element **151** (FIG. **6**) may be moved to a third yet unknown position (x.sub.3|y.sub.3) and the above calculations may be repeated with using the third yet unknown position (x.sub.3|y.sub.3) instead of either one of the first and second yet unknown positions (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and (x.sub.2|y.sub.2).

[0068] Accordingly, if the magnetic sensor arrangement may determine that the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ and the second magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ are identical (or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$), then the magnet-based positioning system **100** may move the magnetic sensor arrangement (having one single sensor element **151** or two sensor elements **151**, **152**) relative to the magnet **110** and may determine a new second magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ at a third yet unknown position (x.sub.3|y.sub.3).

[0069] Of course, also in this case, it may be advantageous to move the magnetic sensor arrangement into a direction different to the first or second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ (forwards along magnetic field

line **140**) and different to the first or second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}} \pm 180^\circ$ (backwards along magnetic field line **140**).

[0070] Again, it may be advantageous to move the magnetic sensor arrangement (having one single sensor element **151** or two sensor elements **151**, **152**) in a direction perpendicular to the first or second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$.

[0071] FIG. 7 shows a further implementation for solving such ambiguity problems. In this implementation, the magnet-based positioning system **100** may further comprise a third magnetic sensor element **153** located at a third yet unknown position ($x_{\text{sub.3}}$ | $y_{\text{sub.3}}$).

[0072] The third magnetic sensor element **153** may be placed on a different axis than the first and second magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152**, such that all three magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152**, **153** may comprise the shape of a triangle. Thus, further ambiguities can be avoided.

[0073] The magnetic sensor arrangement having three magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152**, **153** may be configured to determine a third magnetic field vector **143** at the third yet unknown position ($x_{\text{sub.3}}$ | $y_{\text{sub.3}}$) in the x-y-plane **130**. The magnetic sensor arrangement may also be configured to determine a third magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.3}}$ that describes the angle of the third magnetic field vector **143** extending between the third yet unknown position ($x_{\text{sub.3}}$ | $y_{\text{sub.3}}$) and the common z-axis **111** (=magnetizing axis).

[0074] So, if the magnetic sensor arrangement determines that the first and second magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** are arranged along a common magnetic field line **140**, e.g., if the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ and the second magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ are identical (or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$), then the magnetic sensor arrangement may use the determined third magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.3}}$ instead of one of the first and second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ and to use the determined third magnetic field vector **143** instead of one of the first and second magnetic field vectors **141**, **142**. In this case, the determination of the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the magnet **110** is based on a combination of either one of the first and second magnetic field vectors **141**, **142** and third magnetic field vector **143**.

[0075] Summarizing, the innovative concept suggests three possible solutions for solving the above discussed ambiguities caused by identical first and second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$.

[0076] For a first possible solution, use a third magnetic sensor element **153** and place it in a different axis than the first and second magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** such that all three magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152**, **153** form a triangle:

[0077] With an innovative magnetic sensor arrangement having three magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152**, **153**, it is always possible to instantly determine the relative position between the magnetic sensor arrangement and the magnet **110** in the herein described innovative way. However, the usage of three magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152**, **153** may be more expensive than the above discussed implementations having only two magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** or even only one single magnetic sensor element **151**.

[0078] For a second possible solution, use two magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** and move at least one of the first and second magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** out of the common magnetic field line **140**:

[0079] For positioning purposes either the magnet **110** or the magnetic sensor arrangement may be movable. Thus, if the first and second magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ measured by the first and second magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152** are equal, a movement can be initiated in order to determine the relative position between the magnet **110** and the magnetic sensor arrangement. An exact position calculation is possible with only two magnetic sensor elements **151**, **152**, but not always instantly.

[0080] For a third possible solution, use only one single magnetic sensor element **151** and sequentially move it to different positions:

[0081] According to this implementation, the single sensor element **151** may determine a first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$ at a first position ($x_{\text{sub.1}}$ | $y_{\text{sub.1}}$), then the sensor element **151** may be moved, e.g., perpendicular to the first magnetic field vector **141**, to a second position ($x_{\text{sub.2}}$ | $y_{\text{sub.2}}$), where a second magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$ may be determined. In order to avoid further ambiguities, the single sensor element **151** shall not be moved in the direction of (or away from) the first magnetic field angle $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$.

[0082] This implementation may use only one single sensor element **151** and one magnet **110**, wherein the relative position between the magnetic sensor arrangement and the magnet **110** is not known instantly but it is always known after two measurements (with the movement in between) of the two magnetic field angles $\alpha_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\alpha_{\text{sub.2}}$. Furthermore, the moved distance needs to be known.

[0083] FIG. 8 shows a schematic block diagram of a corresponding method for performing a magnet-based position determination according to the above discussed innovative concept.

[0084] In block **801**, an axially magnetized magnet **110** is provided, wherein two opposing magnetic poles

112, 113 are arranged along a common z-axis **111**.

[0085] In block **802**, a magnetic sensor arrangement is provided, the magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the magnet **110** and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors **141, 142** in an x-y-plane **130** perpendicular to the common z-axis **111**. The magnetic field vectors **141, 142** represent a direction of emanated magnetic field lines **140** in the x-y-plane **130**.

[0086] In block **803**, a first magnetic field vector **141** is determined at a first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) in the x-y-plane **130**, and a second magnetic field vector **142** is determined at a different second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2) in the x-y-plane **130**.

[0087] In block **804**, an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the magnet **110** is determined based on the first and second magnetic field vectors **141, 142** and based on a known relative spatial distance (dx|dy) between the first yet unknown position (x.sub.1|y.sub.1) and the second yet unknown position (x.sub.2|y.sub.2).

[0088] A further implementation concerns a computer-readable storage medium having a computer program stored thereon, for performing, when being executed on a computer or signal processor, the herein described method.

[0089] A further implementation concerns a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium having a computer program, stored thereon, for causing a computer or a signal processor to execute a method for performing a magnet-based position determination using an axially magnetized magnet having two opposing magnetic poles arranged along a common z-axis, and using a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the axially magnetized magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing directions of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane.

[0090] Some or all of the method steps may be executed by (or using) a hardware apparatus, like for example, a microprocessor, a programmable computer or an electronic circuit. In some implementations, one or more of the most important method steps may be executed by such an apparatus.

[0091] Depending on certain implementation requirements, implementations can be implemented in hardware or in software or at least partially in hardware or at least partially in software. The implementation can be performed using a digital storage medium, for example a floppy disk, a DVD, a Blu-Ray, a CD, a ROM, a PROM, an EPROM, an EEPROM or a FLASH memory, having electronically readable control signals stored thereon, which cooperate (or are capable of cooperating) with a programmable computer system such that the respective method is performed. Therefore, the digital storage medium may be computer readable.

[0092] Some implementations comprise a data carrier having electronically readable control signals, which are capable of cooperating with a programmable computer system, such that one of the methods described herein is performed.

[0093] Generally, implementations can be implemented as a computer program product with a program code, the program code being operative for performing one of the methods when the computer program product runs on a computer. The program code may for example be stored on a machine readable carrier.

[0094] Other implementations comprise the computer program for performing one of the methods described herein, stored on a machine readable carrier.

[0095] In other words, an implementation of the inventive method is, therefore, a computer program having a program code for performing one of the methods described herein, when the computer program runs on a computer.

[0096] A further implementation of the inventive methods is, therefore, a data carrier (or a digital storage medium, or a computer-readable medium) comprising, recorded thereon, the computer program for performing one of the methods described herein. The data carrier, the digital storage medium or the recorded medium are typically tangible and/or non-transitory.

[0097] A further implementation of the inventive method is, therefore, a data stream or a sequence of signals representing the computer program for performing one of the methods described herein. The data stream or the sequence of signals may for example be configured to be transferred via a data communication connection, for example via the Internet.

[0098] A further implementation comprises a processing means, for example a computer, or a programmable logic device, configured to or adapted to perform one of the methods described herein.

[0099] A further implementation comprises a computer having installed thereon the computer program for performing one of the methods described herein.

[0100] A further implementation comprises an apparatus or a system configured to transfer (for example, electronically or optically) a computer program for performing one of the methods described herein to a receiver. The receiver may, for example, be a computer, a mobile device, a memory device or the like. The apparatus or system may, for example, comprise a file server for transferring the computer program to the receiver.

[0101] In some implementations, a programmable logic device (for example a field programmable gate array) may be used to perform some or all of the functionalities of the methods described herein. In some implementations, a field programmable gate array may cooperate with a microprocessor in order to perform one of the methods described herein. Generally, the methods are preferably performed by any hardware apparatus.

[0102] The apparatus described herein may be implemented using a hardware apparatus, or using a computer, or using a combination of a hardware apparatus and a computer.

[0103] The methods described herein may be performed using a hardware apparatus, or using a computer, or using a combination of a hardware apparatus and a computer.

[0104] While this disclosure has been described with reference to illustrative implementations, this description is not intended to be construed in a limiting sense. Various modifications and combinations of the illustrative implementations, as well as other implementations of this disclosure, will be apparent to persons skilled in the art upon reference to the description. It is therefore intended that the appended claims encompass any such modifications or implementations.

Aspects

[0105] The following provides an overview of some Aspects of the present disclosure:

[0106] Aspect 1: A magnet-based positioning system, comprising: an axially magnetized magnet, wherein two opposing magnetic poles of the axially magnetized magnet are arranged along a common z-axis; and a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the axially magnetized magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing directions of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and to determine a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and to determine an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0107] Aspect 2: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 1, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine the actual x-y-position based on a triangulation using the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector.

[0108] Aspect 3: The magnet-based positioning system according to any of Aspects 1-2, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: determine a first magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the first magnetic field vector extending between the first yet unknown position and the common z-axis, and determine a second magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the second magnetic field vector extending between the second yet unknown position and the common z-axis.

[0109] Aspect 4: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 3, wherein the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position is known to the magnetic sensor arrangement, and wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine the actual x-y-position relative to the axially magnetized magnet by calculating a spatial distance between at least one of the first yet unknown position or the second yet unknown position and the common z-axis based on the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle and based on the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0110] Aspect 5: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 4, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a first magnetic sensor element located at the first yet unknown position and a second magnetic sensor element located at the second yet unknown position, and wherein a spatial distance between the first magnetic sensor element and the second magnetic sensor element defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0111] Aspect 6: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 4, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a single magnetic sensor element, wherein the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet

unknown position along a predetermined moving distance, wherein the predetermined moving distance defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position, and wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: determine the first magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the first yet unknown position, and determine the second magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the second yet unknown position.

[0112] Aspect 7: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 6, wherein, after determining the first magnetic field angle, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the single magnetic sensor element in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.

[0113] Aspect 8: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 6, wherein, after determining the first magnetic field angle, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the single magnetic sensor element in a direction perpendicular to the first magnetic field angle.

[0114] Aspect 9: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 3, wherein, if the magnetic sensor arrangement determines that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet and to determine the second magnetic field angle at a third yet unknown position.

[0115] Aspect 10: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 9, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle or the second magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$ or different to the second magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.

[0116] Aspect 11: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 5, further comprising: a third magnetic sensor element located at a third yet unknown position, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: determine a third magnetic field vector at the third yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and determine a third magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the third magnetic field vector extending between the third yet unknown position and the common z-axis.

[0117] Aspect 12: The magnet-based positioning system according to Aspect 11, wherein, if the magnetic sensor arrangement determines that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$, the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: use the third magnetic field angle instead of the second magnetic field angle, use the third magnetic field vector instead of the second magnetic field vector, and determine the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the third magnetic field vector.

[0118] Aspect 13: The magnet-based positioning system according to any of Aspects 1-12, wherein the axially magnetized magnet comprises a symmetrical cylinder shape.

[0119] Aspect 14: A method for performing a magnet-based position determination, the method comprising: providing an axially magnetized magnet having two opposing magnetic poles arranged along a common z-axis; providing a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the axially magnetized magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing directions of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane; determining a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; determining a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; and determining an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0120] Aspect 15: The method according to Aspect 14, wherein determining the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet is based on a triangulation using the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector.

[0121] Aspect 16: The method according to any of Aspects 14-15, further comprising: determining a first magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the first magnetic field vector extending between the first yet unknown position and the common z-axis; and determining a second magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the second magnetic field vector extending between the second yet unknown position and the common z-axis.

[0122] Aspect 17: The method according to Aspect 16, wherein the known relative spatial distance between

the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position is known, and wherein the method further comprises: determining the actual x-y-position of the magnet sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet by calculating a spatial distance between at least one of the first yet unknown position or the second yet unknown position and the common z-axis based on the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle and based on the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0123] Aspect 18: The method according to Aspect 17, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a first magnetic sensor element located at the first yet unknown position and a second magnetic sensor element located at the second yet unknown position, and wherein a spatial distance between the first magnetic sensor element and the second magnetic sensor element defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

[0124] Aspect 19: The method according to Aspect 17, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a single magnetic sensor element, wherein the method further comprises: moving the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet unknown position along a predetermined moving distance, wherein the predetermined moving distance defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position; determining the first magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the first yet unknown position; and determining the second magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the second yet unknown position.

[0125] Aspect 20: The method according to Aspect 19, wherein moving the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet unknown position along the predetermined moving distance comprises: moving the single magnetic sensor element in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.

[0126] Aspect 21: The method according to Aspect 19, wherein moving the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet unknown position along the predetermined moving distance comprises: moving the single magnetic sensor element in a direction perpendicular to the first magnetic field angle.

[0127] Aspect 22: The method according to Aspect 16, wherein, based on determining that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$, the method further comprises: moving the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet and determining the second magnetic field angle at a third yet unknown position.

[0128] Aspect 23: The method according to Aspect 22, wherein moving the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet comprises: moving the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle or the second magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$ or different to the second magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.

[0129] Aspect 24: The method according to Aspect 18, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a third magnetic sensor element located at a third yet unknown position, wherein the method further comprises: determining a third magnetic field vector at the third yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; and determining a third magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the third magnetic field vector extending between the third yet unknown position and the common z-axis.

[0130] Aspect 25: The method according to Aspect 24, wherein, based on determining that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$, the method further comprises: using the third magnetic field angle instead of the second magnetic field angle; using the third magnetic field vector instead of the second magnetic field vector; and determining the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the third magnetic field vector.

[0131] Aspect 26: A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium having a computer

[0132] program, stored thereon, for causing a computer or a signal processor to execute a method for performing a magnet-based position determination using an axially magnetized magnet having two opposing magnetic poles arranged along a common z-axis, and using a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the axially magnetized magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing directions of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane, the method comprising: determining a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; determining a second magnetic field vector at a

different second yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; and determining an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

Claims

1. A magnet-based positioning system, comprising: an axially magnetized magnet, wherein two opposing magnetic poles of the axially magnetized magnet are arranged along a common z-axis; and a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the axially magnetized magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing directions of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and to determine a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and to determine an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.
2. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 1, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine the actual x-y-position based on a triangulation using the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector.
3. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 1, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: determine a first magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the first magnetic field vector extending between the first yet unknown position and the common z-axis, and determine a second magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the second magnetic field vector extending between the second yet unknown position and the common z-axis.
4. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 3, wherein the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position is known to the magnetic sensor arrangement, and wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to determine the actual x-y-position relative to the axially magnetized magnet by calculating a spatial distance between at least one of the first yet unknown position or the second yet unknown position and the common z-axis based on the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle and based on the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.
5. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 4, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a first magnetic sensor element located at the first yet unknown position and a second magnetic sensor element located at the second yet unknown position, and wherein a spatial distance between the first magnetic sensor element and the second magnetic sensor element defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.
6. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 4, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a single magnetic sensor element, wherein the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet unknown position along a predetermined moving distance, wherein the predetermined moving distance defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position, and wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: determine the first magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the first yet unknown position, and determine the second magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the second yet unknown position.
7. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 6, wherein, after determining the first magnetic field angle, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the single magnetic sensor element in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.
8. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 6, wherein, after determining the first magnetic field angle, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the single magnetic sensor element in a direction perpendicular to the first magnetic field angle.
9. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 3, wherein, if the magnetic sensor arrangement determines that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted

by $\pm 180^\circ$, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet and to determine the second magnetic field angle at a third yet unknown position.

10. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 9, the magnet-based positioning system is configured to move the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle or the second magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$ or different to the second magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.

11. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 5, further comprising: a third magnetic sensor element located at a third yet unknown position, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: determine a third magnetic field vector at the third yet unknown position in the x-y-plane, and determine a third magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the third magnetic field vector extending between the third yet unknown position and the common z-axis.

12. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 11, wherein, if the magnetic sensor arrangement determines that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$, the magnetic sensor arrangement is configured to: use the third magnetic field angle instead of the second magnetic field angle, use the third magnetic field vector instead of the second magnetic field vector, and determine the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the third magnetic field vectors.

13. The magnet-based positioning system according to claim 1, wherein the axially magnetized magnet comprises a symmetrical cylinder shape.

14. A method for performing a magnet-based position determination, the method comprising: providing an axially magnetized magnet having two opposing magnetic poles arranged along a common z-axis; providing a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the axially magnetized magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing directions of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane; determining a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; determining a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; and determining an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

15. The method according to claim 14, wherein determining the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet is based on a triangulation using the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector.

16. The method according to claim 14, further comprising: determining a first magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the first magnetic field vector extending between the first yet unknown position and the common z-axis; and determining a second magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the second magnetic field vector extending between the second yet unknown position and the common z-axis.

17. The method according to claim 16, wherein the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position is known, and wherein the method further comprises: determining the actual x-y-position of the magnet sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet by calculating a spatial distance between at least one of the first yet unknown position or the second yet unknown position positions and the common z-axis based on the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle and based on the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

18. The method according to claim 17, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a first magnetic sensor element located at the first yet unknown position and a second magnetic sensor element located at the second yet unknown position, and wherein a spatial distance between the first magnetic sensor element and the second magnetic sensor element defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.

19. The method according to claim 17, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a single magnetic sensor element, wherein the method further comprises: moving the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet unknown position along a predetermined moving distance, wherein the predetermined moving distance defines the known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position; determining the first magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the first yet unknown position; and determining the

second magnetic field angle when the single magnetic sensor element is located at the second yet unknown position.

20. The method according to claim 19, wherein moving the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet unknown position along the predetermined moving distance comprises: moving the single magnetic sensor element in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.

21. The method according to claim 19, wherein moving the single magnetic sensor element from the first yet unknown position to the second yet unknown position along the predetermined moving distance comprises: moving the single magnetic sensor element in a direction perpendicular to the first magnetic field angle.

22. The method according to claim 16, wherein, based on determining that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$, the method further comprises: moving the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet and determining the second magnetic field angle at a third yet unknown position.

23. The method according to claim 22, wherein moving the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet comprises: moving the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet in a direction different to the first magnetic field angle or the second magnetic field angle and different to the first magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$ or different to the second magnetic field angle $\pm 180^\circ$.

24. The method according to 18, wherein the magnetic sensor arrangement comprises a third magnetic sensor element located at a third yet unknown position, wherein the method further comprises: determining a third magnetic field vector at the third yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; and determining a third magnetic field angle that describes an angle of the third magnetic field vector extending between the third yet unknown position and the common z-axis.

25. The method according to claim 24, wherein, based on determining that the first magnetic field angle and the second magnetic field angle are identical, or are shifted by $\pm 180^\circ$, the method further comprises: using the third magnetic field angle instead of the second magnetic field angle; using the third magnetic field vector instead of the second magnetic field vector; and determining the actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the third magnetic field vector.

26. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium having a computer program, stored thereon, for causing a computer or a signal processor to execute a method for performing a magnet-based position determination using an axially magnetized magnet having two opposing magnetic poles arranged along a common z-axis, and using a magnetic sensor arrangement being axially spaced apart from the axially magnetized magnet, and being configured to determine magnetic field vectors in an x-y-plane perpendicular to the common z-axis, the magnetic field vectors representing directions of emanated magnetic field lines in the x-y-plane, the method comprising: determining a first magnetic field vector at a first yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; determining a second magnetic field vector at a different second yet unknown position in the x-y-plane; and determining an actual x-y-position of the magnetic sensor arrangement relative to the axially magnetized magnet based on the first magnetic field vector and the second magnetic field vector and based on a known relative spatial distance between the first yet unknown position and the second yet unknown position.
